

Algebraic Coding Theory

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Abstract

Notes taken while studying Algebraic Coding Theory, mostly from Hill book [1] and Lint book [2].

Usually while reading books and papers I take handwritten notes in a notebook, this document contains some of them re-written to *LaTeX*.

The proofs may slightly differ from the ones from the books, since I try to extend them for a deeper understanding.

Contents

1	Vector spaces over finite fields, quick recap	2
2	Linear codes	3
2.1	Some definitions	3
2.2	Equivalence	4
2.3	Encoding with a linear code	4
2.4	Decoding with a linear code	5
2.4.1	Cosets	5
2.5	Probability of error correction (in binary linear codes)	6
2.6	Exercises	8
3	Dual code, PCM and Syndrome	12
3.1	Dual code	12
3.2	PCM (parity-check matrix)	13
3.3	Syndrome	14
3.4	Incomplete decoding	16
3.5	Exercises	16
4	Hamming Codes	19
4.1	Extended binary Hamming codes	21
4.2	q-ary Hamming codes	22
5	MLCT - Main Linear Coding Theory problem	23
5.1	The projective geometry $PG(r-1, q)$	25

6	MDS Codes	26
6.1	Vandermonde determinant	28

1 Vector spaces over finite fields, quick recap

Let q be a prime power.

$V(n, q)$: set $GF(q)^n$ of all ordered n -tuples over $GF(q)$. $V(n, q)$ is a vector space.

A set of vectors $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_r\}$ is said to be *linear dependent* if $\exists$ scalars $a_1, \dots, a_r$, not all zero, such that

$$a_1 v_1 + a_2 v_2 + \dots + a_r v_r = 0$$

They are *linear independent* if

$$a_1 v_1 + a_2 v_2 + \dots + a_r v_r = 0 \implies a_1 = a_2 = \dots = a_r = 0$$

Let C a subspace of $V(n, q)$. Then a subset $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_r\} \subseteq C$ is called a *generating set* (or *spanning set*) of C if every vector in C can be expressed as a linear combination of $v_1, \dots, v_r$.

A generating set of C which is also linearly independent is called a *basis* of C .

Theorem 4.3. Suppose $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_k\}$ is a basis of a subspace C of $V(n, q)$. Then

- i. every vector of C can be expressed uniquely as a linear combination of the basis vectors.
- ii. C contains exactly q^k vectors.

Proof. i. suppose vector $x \in C$ such that

$$x = a_1 v_1 + a_2 v_2 + \dots + a_k v_k$$

$$x = b_1 v_1 + b_2 v_2 + \dots + b_k v_k.$$

then

$$(a_1 - b_1)v_1 + (a_2 - b_2)v_2 + \dots + (a_k - b_k)v_k = 0.$$

But the set $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_k\}$ is linearly independent, and so

$$a_i - b_i = 0 \quad \text{for } i = 1, 2, \dots, k,$$

i.e.,

$$a_i = b_i \quad \text{for } i = 1, 2, \dots, k.$$

ii. By (i), the q^k vectors

$$\sum_{i=1}^k a_i v_i \quad (a_i \in \text{GF}(q))$$

are precisely the distinct vectors of C .

□

2 Linear codes

The theorems of this section are from [1] and follow the original enumeration of the book.

Note about notation:

A q -ary linear code $[n, k, d]$ -code is also a q -ary (n, q^k, d) -code, but the opposite is not always true.

2.1 Some definitions

Let q be a prime power. View $(F_q)^n$ as the vector space $V(n, q)$.

Definition (Linear code over $\text{GF}(q)$). A *linear code over $\text{GF}(q)$* is a subspace of $V(n, q)$, with $n \geq 0$.

Thus $C \subseteq V(n, q)$ is a linear code iff

- i. $u + v \in C \quad \forall u, v \in C$
- ii. $au \in C \quad \forall u \in C, a \in \text{GF}(q)$

If C is a k -dimensional subspace of $V(n, q)$, then the linear code C is called an $[n, k]$ -code. (sometimes with minimum distance d : $[n, k, d]$ -code).

Definition (Weight). Weight, $w(x)$, of a vector $x \in V(n, q)$ is the number of non-zero entries of x .

Lemma 5.1. if $x, y \in V(n, q)$, then $d(x, y) = w(x - y)$.

Proof. the vector $x - y$ has non-zero entries in precisely those places where x and y differ. □

Theorem 5.2. let C a linear code, let $w(C)$ be the smallest of weights of the non-zero codewords of C . Then $d(C) = w(C)$.

Proof. $\exists x, y \in C$ s.th. $d(C) = d(x, y)$.

By Lemma 5.1, $d(C) = w(x - y) \geq w(C)$, since $x - y$ is a codeword of the linear code C (ie. $x - y \in C$).

On the other hand, for $x \in C$,
 $w(C) = w(x) = d(x, 0) \geq d(C)$, since $0 \in C$.

Hence, $d(C) \geq w(C)$ and $w(C) \geq d(C) \implies d(C) = w(C)$. $\square$

Definition (Generator matrix (GM)). a $k \times n$ matrix whose rows form a basis of a linear $[n, k]$ -code is called a *generator matrix* (GM) of the code.

2.2 Equivalence

Theorem 5.4. two known $k \times n$ matrices generate equivalent linear $[n, k]$ -codes over $GF(q)$ if one matrix can be obtained from the other by a sequence of operations of the following types:

- R1. permutation of the rows
- R2. multiplication of a row by a non-zero scalar
- R3. addition of a scalar multiple of one row to another
- C1. permutation of the columns
- C2. multiplication of any column by a non-zero scalar

Theorem 5.5. let G a GM of an $[n, k]$ -code. Then by performing the previous operations, G can be transformed to the standard form $[I_k | A]$ where I_k is the $k \times k$ identity matrix, and A is a $k \times (n - k)$ matrix.

2.3 Encoding with a linear code

Let C a $[n, k]$ -code over $GF(q)$ with GM G . C contains q^k codewords $\implies$ can be used to communicate any one of q^k distinct messages.

Identify these messages with the q^k tuples of $V(k, q)$.

Encoding:

msg vector: $u = u_1 u_2 \dots u_k$; rows of G : $r_1 r_2 \dots r_k$. Encode

$$uG = \sum_{i=1}^k u_i r_i \in C$$

ie. uG is a codeword of C ; a linear combination of the rows of the GM.

Encoding function:

$$\begin{aligned} V(k, q) &\longrightarrow C \subseteq V(n, q) \\ u &\longmapsto uG \end{aligned}$$

If G is in standard form (5.5), $G = [I_k | A]$ with $A = [a_{ij}]$, then encoding u is:

$$x = uG = x_1x_2 \dots x_kx_{k+1} \dots x_n$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} x_i &= u_i \quad \text{for } 1 \leq i \leq k, \text{ message digits} \\ x_{k+i} &= \sum_{j=1}^k a_{ji}u_j \quad \text{for } 1 \leq i \leq n-k, \text{ check digits} \end{aligned}$$

the check digits add redundancy to give protection against noise.

2.4 Decoding with a linear code

Codeword $x = x_1x_2 \dots x_n$, received vector $y = y_1y_2 \dots y_n$, error vector $e = y - x = e_1e_2 \dots e_n$.

2.4.1 Cosets

Cosets here are similar to the ones from typical group theory, just from another perspective.

Definition (Coset). Let C a $[n, k]$ -code over $GF(q)$ and $a \in V(n, q)$. Then the set $a + C = \{a + x | x \in C\}$ is called a *coset* of C .

Definition (Coset leader). the vector having minimum weight in a coset is called the *coset leader*.

Lemma 6.3. Let $a + C$ a coset of C and $b \in a + C$. Then $b + C = a + C$.

Proof. since $b \in a + C \implies b = a + x$ for some $x \in C$. If $b + y \in b + C$ then

$$b + y = (a + x) + y = a + (x + y) \in a + C$$

For the other direction, if $a + x \in a + C$ then

$$a + x = (b - x) + z = b + (z - x) \in b + C$$

hence $a + C \subseteq b + C$.

Therefore $b + C = a + C$. □

Theorem 6.4 (Lagrange). suppose $C \subseteq V(n, q)$ is a $[n, k]$ -code over $GF(q)$. Then

- i. every vector of $V(n, q)$ is in some coset of C
- ii. every coset contains exactly q^k vectors
- iii. two cosets either are disjoint or coincide (partial overlap is impossible)

Proof. i. if $a \in V(n, q)$ then $a = a + 0 \in a + C$

ii. the map

$$\begin{aligned} C &\longrightarrow a + C \quad \forall x \in C \\ x &\longmapsto a + x \end{aligned}$$

is a one-to-one map, hence $|a + C| = |C| = q^k$.

iii. by contradiction, suppose cosets $a + C$, $b + C$ overlap. Then for some vector v ,

$$v \in (a + C) \cap (b + C)$$

thus for some $x, y \in C$, $v = a + x = b + y$.

Hence $b = a + (x - y) \in a + C$, thus by Lemma 6.3 we have $b + C = a + C$. $\square$

Corollary . 6.4 shows that $V(n, q)$ is partitioned into disjoint cosets of C :

$$V(n, q) = (0 + C) \cup (a_1 + C) \cup \dots \cup (a_s + C)$$

where $s = q^{n-k} - 1$, and by Lemma 6.3 we may take $0, a_1, \dots, a_s$ to be coset leaders.

Example 6.5. Let C be the binary $[4, 2]$ -code with generator matrix

$$G = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

ie. $C = \{0000, 1011, 0101, 1110\}$.

Then the cosets of C are

$$\begin{aligned} 0000 + C &= C \text{ itself} \\ 1000 + C &= \{1000, 0011, 1101, 0110\} \\ 0100 + C &= \{0100, 1111, 0001, 1010\} = 0001 + C \\ 0010 + C &= \{0010, 1001, 0111, 1100\} \end{aligned}$$

by Lemma 6.3: $0001 \in 0100 + C$, thus $0001 + C = 0100 + C$.

2.5 Probability of error correction (in binary linear codes)

To evaluate how good a code is, must calculate the *probability* that a received vector will be decoded as the codeword which was sent.

Let p be the symbol error probability.

Probability that the error vector is given vector of weight i is $p^i(1-p)^{n-i}$.

Theorem 6.7. Let C a binary $[n, k]$ -code, and for $i = 0, 1, \dots, n$ let α_i denote the number of coset leaders of weight i .

Then the probability $P_{corr}(C)$ that a received vector decoded by means of a standard array is the codeword which was sent is

$$P_{corr}(C) = \sum_{i=0}^n \alpha_i \cdot p^i (1-p)^{n-i}$$

Example 6.8. $[n, k]$ -code from 6.5, coset leaders are 0000, 1000, 0100, 0010. Hence $\alpha_0 = 1$, $\alpha_1 = 3$, $\alpha_2 = \alpha_3 = \alpha_4 = 0$, so

$$P_{corr}(C) = (1-p)^4 + 3p(1-p)^3 = (1-p)^3(1+2p)$$

Remark 6.9. if $d(C) = 2t+1$ or $d(C) = 2t+2$, then C can correct any t errors.

Hence every vector of weight $\leq t$ is a coset leader and so $\alpha_i = \binom{n}{i}$ for $0 \leq i \leq t$.

Definition (Rate). $[n, k]$ -code C uses n symbols to send k message symbols; it has *rate* $R(C) = k/n$.

A good code will have a high rate.

Definition (Capacity). the *capacity* $\mathcal{C}(p)$ of a binary symmetric channel with symbol error probability p is

$$\mathcal{C}(p) = 1 + p \cdot \log_2(p) + (1-p) \cdot \log_2(1-p)$$

Theorem 6.12 (Shanon's theorem). channel binary symmetric with symbol error probability p .

Let $R < \mathcal{C}(p)$.

Then for any $\epsilon > 0$, $\exists$ for sufficient large n , an $[n, k]$ -code C of rate $k/n \geq R$ such that $P_{err}(C) < \epsilon$.

Definition (P_{symb}). P_{symb} denotes the average probability that a message symbol is in error after decoding.

Theorem 6.14. let C a binary $[n, k]$ -code and let A_i denote the number of codewords of C of weight i .

Then, if C is used for error detection, the probability of an incorrect message being undetected is

$$P_{undetec}(C) = \sum_{i=1}^n A_i \cdot p^i (1-p)^{n-i}$$

Example 6.15. for the code of 6.5,

$$P_{undetec}(C) = \underbrace{1 \cdot p^2(1-p)^2}_{0101} + \underbrace{2 \cdot p^3(1-p)^{4-3=1}}_{1011, 1110} = p^2 - p^4$$

2.6 Exercises

Exercise 5.1. is the binary $(11, 24, 5)$ -code linear?

Proof. recall: a q -ary linear $[n, k, d]$ -code is also a q -ary (n, q^k, d) -code, but the opposite is not always true.

$\implies$ $(11, 24, 5)$ -code to be linear it would mean that $24 = q^k$.

Since it is binary, $q = 2$. But $24 \neq 2^k$, so it can not be linear. $\square$

Exercise 5.2. E_n is the code of all even-weight vectors of $V(n, 2)$, which is linear. What are the parameters $[n, k, d]$ of E_n ? Write a GM for E_n in standard form.

Proof.

$$E_n = \{x \in V(n, 2) | w(x) \text{ is even}\}$$

$\longrightarrow$ is the binary even-weight code (the single parity-check code);
it's linear since

- the zero vector has even weight
- over $GF(2)$, the sum of two even-weight vectors has even weight

Recall: $F_q^n \iff V(n, q)$, so $V(n, 2) \cong F_2^n$

$$\implies E_n = \{(x_1, \dots, x_n) \in F_2^n | x_1 + \dots + x_n = 0\}$$

minimum distance is 2, since

- no word of weight 1 is in E_n
- words of weight 2 are in E_n

Therefore, parameters are $[n, n-1, 2]$

GM:

$$G = [I_{n-1} | 1]$$

which generates vectors of the form

$$(a_1, \dots, a_{n-1}, a_1 + \dots + a_{n-1})$$

$\square$

Exercise 5.5. Prove that in a *binary linear code*, either all the codewords have even weight or exactly half have even weight and half odd weight.

Proof. let C_e , C_o be subsets of C with even and odd weights respectively.

So that $C = C_e \cup C_o$ (disjoint union).

For binary vectors x, y :

$$w(x + y) = w(x) + w(y) \pmod{2}$$

ie. over F_2 , the parity of the weight is additive:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{even} + \text{even} &= \text{even} \\ \text{even} + \text{odd} &= \text{odd} \\ \text{odd} + \text{odd} &= \text{even} \end{aligned}$$

Now we have two possible cases:

- C has no odd weighted codewords:
 $C_0 = \emptyset, \forall x \in C \text{ } x \text{ is even weighted}$
- C has at least one odd-weighted codeword:
let $u \in C_o$, consider the map

$$\begin{aligned} \phi : C_e &\longrightarrow C_o \\ c &\longmapsto c + u \end{aligned}$$

with $c \in C_e, u \in C_o, \phi(c) \in C_o$.

ϕ is bijective, since $\phi(\phi(c)) = (c + u) + u = c$,

so ϕ is it's own inverse; hence $|C_e| = |C_o|$.

Since $C = C_e \cup C_o$, half codewords are even weighted and half odd.

□

Exercise 6.1. construct standard arrays for codes having each of the GMs:

$$G_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad G_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Proof. recall: for a binary code with GM G , the code C consists of all binary linear combinations of the rows of G .

For G_1 :

rows: $r_1 = (1, 0), r_2 = (0, 1)$. A codeword is any linear combination:

$$uG_1 = a \cdot r_1 + b \cdot r_2, \text{ with } a, b \in \{0, 1\}$$

4 combinations:

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \cdot r_1 + 0 \cdot r_2 &= (0, 0) \\ 1 \cdot r_1 + 0 \cdot r_2 &= (1, 0) \\ 0 \cdot r_1 + 1 \cdot r_2 &= (0, 1) \\ 1 \cdot r_1 + 1 \cdot r_2 &= (1, 0) + (0, 1) = (1, 1) \end{aligned}$$

$$\implies C_1 = \{00, 10, 01, 11\}$$

standard array: 00 01 10 11

For G_2 :
rows: $r_1 = (1, 0, 1)$, $r_2 = (0, 1, 1)$. Codeword: $a \cdot r_1 + b \cdot r_2$ with $a, b \in \{0, 1\}$.
4 combinations:

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \cdot r_1 + 0 \cdot r_2 &= (0, 0, 0) \\ 1 \cdot r_1 + 0 \cdot r_2 &= (1, 0, 1) \\ 0 \cdot r_1 + 1 \cdot r_2 &= (0, 1, 1) \\ 1 \cdot r_1 + 1 \cdot r_2 &= (1, 0, 1) + (0, 1, 1) = (1, 1, 0) \end{aligned}$$

$$\implies C_2 = \{000, 101, 011, 110\}$$

$\implies$ so the 1st row of the standard array is: 000 101 011 110.

Now, pick a non used vector: 001, add it to the code C_2 :

$$\begin{aligned} 001 + C_{2_i} \\ 001 + 000 &= 001 \\ 001 + 101 &= 100 \\ 001 + 011 &= 010 \\ 001 + 110 &= 111 \end{aligned}$$

$\implies$ 2nd row of the standard array: 001 100 010 111

Thus the standard array is

$$\begin{array}{cccc} 000 & 101 & 011 & 110 \\ 001 & 100 & 010 & 111 \end{array}$$

ie. $2^3 = 8$ vectors, a $V(3, 2)$ vector space. $\square$

Exercise 6.4. C a binary $[n, k]$ -code with minimum distance $2t + 1$ (or $2t + 2$). Given that p is very small, show that an approximate value of $P_{err}(C)$ is $\left(\binom{n}{t+1} - \alpha_{t+1}\right)p^{t+1}$, where α_{t+1} is the number of coset leaders of C of weight $t + 1$.

Proof. From 6.9, if $d(C) = 2t + 1$ (or $2t + 2$) $\implies C$ can correct any t errors.

Hence every vector of weight $\leq t$ is a coset leader and so $\alpha_i = \binom{n}{i}$ for $0 \leq i \leq t$.

$$P_{corr}(C) = \sum_{i=0}^n \alpha_i \cdot p^i (1-p)^{n-i} \quad (1)$$

where α_i is the number of coset leaders of weight i

From the $\binom{n}{i}$ vectors of weight i , exactly α_i are coset leaders, so the non coset leaders are $\binom{n}{i} - \alpha_i$. This is when a decoding error happens.

$$\implies P_{err}(C) = \sum_{i=0}^n \left(\binom{n}{i} - \alpha_i \right) p^i (1-p)^{n-i}$$

Alternatively from 1:

$$P_{err}(C) = 1 - P_{corr}(C) = 1 - \sum_{i=0}^n \alpha_i \cdot p^i (1-p)^{n-i}$$

Notice that

$$\sum_{i=0}^n \binom{n}{i} p^i (1-p)^{n-i} = (p + (1-p))^n = 1^n = 1$$

thus

$$\begin{aligned} P_{err}(C) &= \sum_{i=0}^n \binom{n}{i} p^i (1-p)^{n-i} - \sum_{i=0}^n \alpha_i \cdot p^i (1-p)^{n-i} \\ &= \sum_{i=0}^n \left(\binom{n}{i} - \alpha_i \right) p^i (1-p)^{n-i} \end{aligned}$$

Now, from 6.9, $\forall i \leq t$, $\alpha_i = \binom{n}{i}$, thus $\binom{n}{i} - \alpha_i = 0$ for the first t terms in the sum.

Thus

$$\begin{aligned} P_{err}(C) &= \sum_{i=0}^n \left(\binom{n}{i} - \alpha_i \right) p^i (1-p)^{n-i} \\ &= \left(\binom{n}{t+1} - \alpha_{t+1} \right) p^{t+1} (1-p)^{n-t-1} + \dots \end{aligned}$$

where the $\dots$ represent the terms with p^{t+2} and higher.

Then, since p is very small (by the exercise definition), $(1-p)^{n-t-1} \equiv 1$, and the other higher powers of p are negligible.

Hence,

$$P_{err}(C) = \left(\binom{n}{t+1} - \alpha_{t+1} \right) \cdot p^{t+1}$$

□

3 Dual code, PCM and Syndrome

3.1 Dual code

Definition (Orthogonal). Inner product:

$$u \cdot v = u_1v_1 + \dots + u_nv_n = \sum_{i=1}^n u_iv_i$$

If $u \cdot v = 0$, then u and v are called *orthogonal*.

Lemma 7.1. for any $u, v, w \in V(n, q)$ and $\lambda, \mu \in GF(q)$,

- i. $u \cdot v = v \cdot u$
- ii. $(\lambda u + \mu v) \cdot w = \lambda(u \cdot w) + \mu(v \cdot w)$

Proof. (at exercise 7.1). □

Definition (Dual code). given a linear $[n, k]$ -code C , the *dual code* of C , denoted $C^\perp$, is defined to be the set of those vectors of $V(n, q)$ which are orthogonal to every codeword of C . ie.

$$C^\perp = \{v \in V(n, q) \mid v \cdot u = 0 \ \forall u \in C\}$$

Lemma 7.2. C a $[n, k]$ -code with GM G . Then $v \in V(n, q)$ belongs to $C^\perp$ iff v is orthogonal to every row of G , ie.

$$v \in C^\perp \iff v \cdot G^T = 0$$

Proof. let rows of G be $r_1, \dots, r_k$, suppose $v \cdot r_i = 0 \ \forall i$ (ie. v orthogonal to every row of G).

If $u \in C$ (ie. a codeword of C), then $u = \sum_{i=1}^k \lambda_i r_i$ for some scalars λ_i , so that

$$v \cdot u = v \cdot \sum_{i=1}^k \lambda_i r_i = \sum_{i=1}^k \lambda_i \cdot \underbrace{(v \cdot r_i)}_0 = \sum \lambda_i \cdot 0 = 0$$

$\implies$ hence v is orthogonal to every codeword of C , and so is in $C^\perp$. □

Theorem 7.3. C a $[n, k]$ -code over $GF(q)$. Then the dual code $C^\perp$ of C is a linear $[n, n - k]$ -code.

Proof. i. first show that $C^\perp$ is a linear code:

let $v_1, v_2 \in C^\perp$ and $\lambda, \mu \in GF(q)$. Then $\forall u \in C$,

$$(\lambda v_1 + \mu v_2) \cdot u = \lambda(v_1 \cdot u) + \mu(v_2 \cdot u)$$

notice that $v_1, v_2 \in C^\perp$, so

that v_1, v_2 are orthogonal with u

hence $(v_1 \cdot u)$ and $(v_2 \cdot u)$ are 0

$$= \lambda \cdot 0 + \mu \cdot 0 = 0$$

Hence $\lambda \cdot v_1 + \mu \cdot v_2 \in C^\perp$, and so $C^\perp$ is linear, since it is closed under linear combinations.

ii. Next, show that $C^\perp$ has dimension $n - k$:

Let $G = [g_{ij}]$ be a GM of C .

Then by Lemma 7.2, the elements of $C^\perp$ are the vectors $v = (v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n)$, since $v \in C^\perp \iff v \cdot G^T = 0$, satisfying

$$\sum_{j=1}^m g_{ij} v_j = 0, \forall i = [k]$$

$\longrightarrow$ this is a system of k independent homogeneous equations in n unknowns, with solution space $C^\perp$. From linear algebra we know that it has dimension $n - k$. To see it:

if codes C_1 and C_2 are equivalent, then $C_1^\perp$, $C_2^\perp$ are also equivalent. Hence is enough to show that $\dim(C^\perp) = n - k$, where C is a standard form GM:

$$C = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \dots & 0 & a_{1,1} & \dots & a_{1,n-k} \\ \vdots & & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ 0 & \dots & 1 & a_{k,1} & \dots & a_{k,n-k} \end{pmatrix}$$

Then

$$C^\perp = \{(v_1, \dots, v_n) \in V(n, q) \mid v_i + \sum_{j=1}^{n-k} a_{i,j} v_{k+j} = 0, i = 1, 2, \dots, k\}$$

For each of the q^{n-k} choices of $(v_{k+1}, \dots, v_n)$, $\exists! (v_1, v_2, \dots, v_k) \in C^\perp$.

Hence $|C^\perp| = q^{n-k}$, therefore $\dim(C^\perp) = n - k$. □

Theorem 7.5. for any $[n, k]$ -code C , $(C^\perp)^\perp = C$.

Proof. clearly $C \subseteq (C^\perp)^\perp$, since every vector in C is orthogonal to every vector in $C^\perp$.

But $\dim((C^\perp)^\perp) = n - (n - k) = k = \dim(C)$, therefore $C = (C^\perp)^\perp$. □

3.2 PCM (parity-check matrix)

Definition (PCM). A *parity-check matrix* (PCM) H for a $[n, k]$ -code C is a generator matrix of $C^\perp$.

$\implies H$ is a $(n - k) \times n$ matrix satisfying $GH^T = 0$.

From 7.2 and 7.5,
if H a PCM of C , then

$$C = \{x \in V(n, q) \mid xH^T = 0\}$$

$\implies$ Any linear code is completely specified by a PCM.

Intuition . i. PCM: G specifies how to build a codeword, the PCM H specifies the rules a vector must follow to be considered a valid codeword.

ii. dual-code: orthogonal "shadow", see C as a plane through 3D origin; $C^\perp$ is the (normal vector) line emerging from the plane.

Rows of the PCM are the basis for the dual-code $C^\perp \implies$ ie. the rules that define C are themselves a code.

Theorem 7.6. if $G = [I_k | A]$ is the standard form generator matrix of an $[n, k]$ -code C , then a PCM for C is $H = [-A^T \mid I_{n-k}]$.

eg.

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \dots & 0 & a_{1,1} & \dots & a_{1,n-k} \\ \vdots & & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ 0 & \dots & 1 & a_{k,1} & \dots & a_{k,n-k} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} -a_{1,1} & \dots & -a_{1,n-k} & 1 & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ -a_{k,1} & \dots & -a_{k,n-k} & 0 & \dots & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

which, in binary, the minus signs are unnecessary.

Definition (Standard form). a PCM that is $H = [B \mid I_{n-k}]$

3.3 Syndrome

Definition (Syndrome). let H a PCM of a $[n, k]$ -code C .

Then $\forall y \in V(n, q)$, the $1 \times (n - k)$ row vector

$$S(y) = yH^T$$

is called the *syndrome* of y .

Remark . i. for $h_1, h_2, \dots, h_{n-k}$ being rows of H , then

$$S(y) = (y \cdot h_1, y \cdot h_2, \dots, y \cdot h_{n-k})$$

ii. $S(y) = 0 \iff y \in C$

Intuition . Syndrome is the "symptom" of the error. It ignores the valid part of the message and isolates the noise.

$$S(y) = yH^T = (c + e)H^T = \underbrace{cH^T}_0 + eH^T = 0 + eH^T = eH^T$$

Syndrome allows the receiver to identify what went wrong without knowing what was originally sent.

Lemma 7.8. two vectors u, v are the same coset of C iff they have the same syndrome.

Proof. if u, v in the same coset of C

$$\begin{aligned} \implies u + C &= v + C \\ \implies u - v &\in C \\ \implies (u - v)H^T &= 0 \\ \implies uH^T &= vH^T \\ \implies S(u) &= S(v) \end{aligned}$$

□

Corollary 7.9. There is a one-to-one correspondence between cosets and syndromes.

→ for small n , it's fast to locate the received vector y in the array, but for large n : use syndrome to find which coset (ie. which row of the array) contains y .

Example 7.9. (from example 6.5)

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

by 7.6,

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Hence the syndromes of the coset leaders are

$$\begin{aligned} S(0000) &= 00 \\ S(1000) &= 11 \\ S(0100) &= 01 \\ S(0010) &= 10 \end{aligned}$$

The standard array becomes:

<i>coset leaders</i>				<i>syndromes</i>
0000	1011	0101	1110	00
1000	0011	1101	0110	11
0100	1111	0001	1010	01
0010	1001	0111	1100	10

so, decoding algorithm: when a vector y is received, calculate $S(y) = yH^T$, locate $S(y)$ in the *syndromes* column of the array.

Locate y in the corresponding row and decode as the codeword at the top of the column containing y .

→ in practice: *syndrome lookup table*:

syndrome z	coset leader $f(z)$
00	0000
11	1000
01	0100
10	0010

decoding procedure:

1. receive y , calculate $S(y) = yH^T$
2. let $z = S(y)$, locate z in the first column of the lookup table
3. decode y as $y - f(z)$

3.4 Incomplete decoding

For $d(C) = 2t + 1$ (or $2t + 2$), guarantee the correction of $\leq t$ errors in any codeword and also detect some cases of more than t errors.

→ Arrange the cosets in order of increasing weight of the coset leaders.

Divide the array into a top part and a bottom part; top: cosets whose leaders have weights $\leq t$.

- If y in top part: decode as usual (assuming $\leq t$ errors).
- If y in bottom part: conclude that $> t$ errors have occurred, ask for retransmission.

3.5 Exercises

Exercise 7.1. prove Lemma 7.1

Proof. For any $u, v, w \in V(n, q)$ and $\lambda, \mu \in GF(q)$,

- i. $u \cdot v = v \cdot u$

$$u \cdot v = \sum_{i=1}^n u_i \cdot v_i = \sum_{i=1}^n v_i \cdot u_i = v \cdot u$$

ii. $(\lambda u + \mu v) \cdot w = \lambda(u \cdot w) + \mu(v \cdot w)$

$$\begin{aligned}
(\lambda u + \mu v)w &= \sum (\lambda u_i + \mu v_i)w_i \\
&= \sum (\lambda u_i w_i + \mu v_i w_i) \\
&= \sum (\lambda u_i w_i) + \sum (\mu v_i w_i) \\
&= \lambda \sum (u_i w_i) + \mu \sum (v_i w_i) \\
&= \lambda \cdot (u \cdot w) + \mu \cdot (v \cdot w)
\end{aligned}$$

□

Exercise 7.2. prove that if E_n is the binary even weight code of length n , then $E_n^\perp$ is the repetition code of length n .

Proof. from exercise 5.2:

$$E_n = \{x \in V(n, 2) \mid w(x) \text{ is even}\} = \{(x_1, \dots, x_n) \in F_2^n \mid x_1 + \dots + x_n = 0\}$$

GM of E_n :

$$G = \left[I_{n-1} \mid \begin{array}{c} 1 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{array} \right]$$

thus, by 7.6, PCM is $H = [1 \ 1 \ \dots \ 1]$.

If H is a PCM for C , then the rows of H generate $C^\perp$.

Therefore

$$E_n^\perp = \langle \underbrace{[1 \ 1 \ \dots \ 1]}_{\text{generator}} \rangle$$

then it's codewords are:

$$0 \cdot (1, \dots, 1) = (0, \dots, 0)$$

$$1 \cdot (1, \dots, 1) = (1, \dots, 1)$$

$$\implies E_n^\perp = \{00 \dots 00, 11 \dots 1\}$$

ie. the repetition code of length n .

□

Exercise 7.4. for a binary linear code with PCM H , show that the transpose of the syndrome of a received vector is equal to the sums of those columns of H corresponding to where the errors occurred.

Proof. Let e the error, y the vector received, and x the original codeword. Then $y = x + e$.

Then

$$S(y) = yH^T = (x + e)H^T = \underbrace{xH^T}_{\substack{0, \text{ since } H \\ \text{is PCM of } C \\ \text{and } x \in C}} + eH^T = eH^T$$

So,

$$S(y)^T = e^T H = \sum_{j=1}^n e_j \cdot H_j$$

where H_j is the j -th column of H . □

Exercise 7.6. Let C be the ternary linear code with GM

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- (a) Find a generator matrix in standard form.
- (b) Find a parity check matrix (PCM) for C in standard form.
- (c) Use syndrome decoding to decode the received vectors: 2122, 1201, 2222

Proof. (a)

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 2 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

thus $G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 2 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is PCM in standard form.

- (b) since $G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 2 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ then

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} -2 & -2 & 1 & 0 \\ -2 & -1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- (c)

$$S(y) = yH^T = S(y) = (y \cdot h_1, y \cdot h_2).$$

w/ h_i the rows of H .

compute the lookup table (syndrome table):

e	$S(e)$
0000	00
1000	11
2000	22
0100	12
0200	21
0010	10
0020	20
0001	01
0002	02

left: weight-1 errors, since we're over F_3 ; right: coset leaders for the 9 cosets.

i. $y = 2121$:

$$S(y) = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = [5, 5] \equiv [2, 2].$$

$S(y) = [2, 2]$, corresponds (in the table) to $e = 2000$.

$$\implies c = y - e = 2121 - 2000 = 0121$$

ii. $y = 1201$

$$S(y) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} H^T = [3, 6] = [0, 0].$$

corresponds to $e = 0000$

$$\implies c = y - e = 1201$$

iii. $y = 2222$

$$S(y) = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 2 & 2 & 2 \end{bmatrix} H^T = [6, 8] = [0, 2].$$

corresponds to $e = 0002$

$$\implies c = y - e = 2222 - 0002 = 2220$$

□

4 Hamming Codes

Definition (Binary Hamming Code). let r a positive integer, H a $r \times (2^r - 1)$ matrix whose columns are the distinct non-zero vectors of $V(r, 2)$.

The code having H as its PCM is called a *binary Hamming code*, denoted $Ham(r, 2)$.

Remark . $Ham(r, 2)$ has length $n = 2^r - 1$ and dimension $k = n - r$.

Redundancy of the code: $r = n - k$, the number of check symbols in each codeword.

Exercise 8.1. i. $r = 2$: $H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$

by Theorem 7.6, $G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & \underbrace{1}_I \end{bmatrix}$

so $Ham(2, 2)$ is just the binary triple repetition code.

ii. $r = 3$: a PCM for $Ham(3, 2)$ is

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

(have taken columns in the natural order of increasing binary numbers from 1 to 7)

H in standard form: rearrange columns:

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

by Theorem 7.6, a generator matrix for $Ham(3, 2)$ is

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Theorem 8.2. the binary Hamming code $Ham(r, 2)$, for $r \geq 2$,

1. is a $[2^r - 1, 2^r - 1 - r]$ -code
2. has minimum distance 3 (hence is single-error-correcting)
3. is a *perfect code*

Lemma (Decoding with a binary Hamming code). $Ham(r, 2)$ is a perfect single-error-correcting code $\implies$ the coset leader are precisely the 2^r ($= n + 1$) vectors of $V(n, 2)$ of weight ≤ 1 .

Let j -th column of H be the binary representation of j . Decoding algorithm:

1. receive vector y , calculate its syndrome: $S(y) = yH^T$
2. if $S(y) = 0$, assume $y = c$ (original sent codeword)
3. if $S(y) \neq 0$, assuming a single error, $S(y)$ gives the binary representation of the error position, and the error can be corrected.

Example . $H = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, if $y = 1101011$ then

$$S(y) = y \cdot H^T = 110$$

$\implies$ 6-th position, and so we decode y as 1101001

4.1 Extended binary Hamming codes

$\hat{Ham}(r, 2)$, obtained from $Ham(r, 2)$ by adding an overall parity-check.

Not ideal for complete decoding, but good for incomplete decoding (correct any single error and detect any double error).

Let H be a PCM for $Ham(r, 2)$. A PCM $\hat{H}$ for $\hat{Ham}(r, 2)$:

$$\hat{H} = \begin{bmatrix} & & & 0 \\ & H & & \vdots \\ & & & 0 \\ 1 & \cdots & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

If H is taken with columns in increasing order of binary numbers, we have a neat incomplete decoding algorithm:

Example 8.3. $r = 3$, $\hat{Ham}(3, 2)$. Received y , $S(y) = y\hat{H}^T = (s_1, s_2, s_3, s_4)$

- i. if $s_4 = 0$ and $(s_1, s_2, s_3) = 0$: assume no errors
- ii. if $s_4 = 0$ and $(s_1, s_2, s_3) \neq 0$: assume ≥ 2 errors and ask retransmission
- iii. if $s_4 = 1$ and $(s_1, s_2, s_3) = 0$: assume 1 error in the last position
- iv. if $s_4 = 1$ and $(s_1, s_2, s_3) \neq 0$: assume 1 error in the j -th position, where j is the number binary-represented by (s_1, s_2, s_3)

Theorem 8.4. suppose C a linear $[n, k]$ -code over $GF(q)$ with PCM H . Minimum distance of C is d iff any $d - 1$ columns of H are linearly independent but some d columns are linearly dependent.

Proof. by 5.2, min. distance of C (ie. $d(C)$) = smallest of the weights of the non-zero codewords.

Let $x = x_1x_2 \dots x_n \in V(n, q)$, then

$$\begin{aligned} x \in C &\iff xH^T = 0 \\ &\iff x_1H_1 + x_2H_2 + \dots + x_nH_n = 0 \end{aligned}$$

where H_i denote the columns of H .

$\implies$ each codeword x of weight d corresponds with a set of d linearly dependent columns of H .

On the other hand, if $\exists$ a set of $d - 1$ lin.dependent columns of H , say $H_{i_1}, H_{i_2}, \dots, H_{i_{d-1}}$, then $\exists x_{i_1}, \dots, x_{i_{d-1}}$ scalars, not all zero, such that

$$x_{i_1}H_{i_1} + x_{i_2}H_{i_2} + \dots + x_{i_{d-1}}H_{i_{d-1}} = 0$$

But then, the vector

$$x = (0 \dots 0x_{i_1}0 \dots x_{i_2}0 \dots 0x_{i_{d-1}}0 \dots 0)$$

having x_{i_j} in the j -th position for $j \in [d-1]$, would satisfy $xH^T = 0$, and so would be a non-zero codeword of weight $< d$. $\square$

4.2 q-ary Hamming codes

For C a linear code with $d(C) = 3$ (min.dist), any 2 columns of a PCM H must be linearly independent

$\implies$ columns of H must be non-zero, and no column can be a scalar multiple of another

Any $0 \neq v \in V(r, q)$ vector has $q-1$ non-zero scalar multiples, forming the set

$$\{\lambda v \mid \lambda \in GF(q), \lambda \neq 0\}$$

$\longrightarrow$ the $q^r - 1$ non-zero vectors of $V(r, q)$ may be partitioned into $\frac{q^r - 1}{q - 1}$ such sets, called *classes*.

$\longrightarrow$ two vectors are scalar multiples of each other if they are in the same class

By choosing one vector from each class, obtain a set of $\frac{q^r - 1}{q - 1}$ vectors, where not two are linearly dependent.

By Theorem 8.4, taking these as columns of h gives a PCM for a

$$\left[\frac{q^r - 1}{q - 1}, \frac{q^r - 1}{(q - 1) - r}, 3 \right] \text{-code}$$

$\implies$ called *q-ary Hamming code*, $Ham(r, q)$.

$\longrightarrow$ PCM is unique up to permutation of columns

$\implies$ Hamming codes are linear codes

Theorem 8.6. $Ham(r, q)$ is a perfect single-error-correcting code.

Proof. $Ham(r, q)$ is constructed to be a $(n, M, 3)$ -code, with $n = \frac{q^r - 1}{q - 1}$ and $M = q^{n-r}$.

With $t = 1$, the LHS of the sphere-packing bound becomes

$$q^{n-r} \cdot (1 + n(q - 1)) = q^{n-r} \cdot (1 + q^r - 1) = q^n$$

which is the RHS, so $Ham(r, q)$ is a perfect code. $\square$

Decoding q-ary Hamming code Since Ham is perfect single-error correcting code, the coset leaders, other than 0, are the vectors of weight 1.

Syndrome of such coset leader:

$$S(0 \dots 0 b 0 \dots 0) = (0 \dots 0 b 0 \dots 0) \cdot H^T = b \cdot H_j^T$$

where H_j is the j -th column of H , and b is at the j -th position of y .

Decode:

- given received y , calculate $S(y) = yH^T$
- if $S(y) = 0$, assume no errors
- if $S(y) \neq 0$, then $S(y) = b \cdot H_j^T$ for some b and j
correct by: subtract b from the j -th entry of y .

Example:

$$q = 5, H = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}, y = 203031$$

Then,

$$\begin{aligned} S(y) &= y \cdot H^T = 2 \cdot H_1^T + 3 \cdot H_3^T + 3 \cdot H_5^T + 1 \cdot H_6^T \\ &= 2 \cdot [0 \ 1] + 3 \cdot [1 \ 1] + 3 \cdot [1 \ 3] + 1 \cdot [1 \ 4] \\ &= [0 \ 2] + [3 \ 3] + [3 \ 9] + [1 \ 4] \\ &= [7 \ 8] = [2 \ 3] = \underbrace{2}_b \cdot \underbrace{[1 \ 4]}_{H_6^T} \pmod{5} \end{aligned}$$

$\Rightarrow$ error is in position 6-th, with magnitude $b = 2$
 $\Rightarrow$ subtract b from the j -th entry of y : $1 - 2 \pmod{5} = -1 \pmod{5} = 4$,
therefore $y' = 203034$.

5 MLCT - Main Linear Coding Theory problem

A good (n, M, d) -code has

- small n , for fast transmission of messages
- large M , to enable transmission of a wide variety of messages
- large d , to correct many errors

Denote by $A_q(n, d)$ the largest M such that $\exists$ a q -ary (n, M, d) -code.

Theorem 2.7. Suppose d is odd. Then a binary (n, M, d) -code exists iff a binary $(n + 1, M, d + 1)$ -code exists.

Proof. □

Corollary 2.8. If d is odd, then $A_2(n + 1, d + 1) = A_2(n, d)$.

Equivalently, if d is even, then $A_2(n, d) = A_2(n - 1, d - 1)$.

Definition (Sphere). $\forall u \in F_q^n$ (vector) and any integer $r \geq 0$, the *sphere* of radius r and centre u , denoted $S(u, r)$, is the set

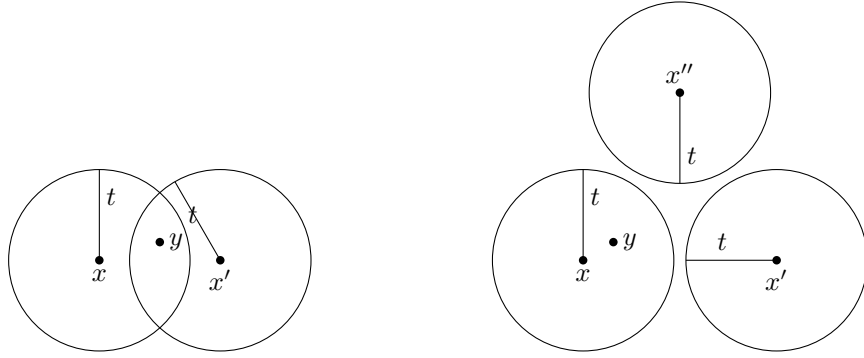
$$\{v \in F_q^n \mid d(u, v) \leq r\}$$

Theorem 1.9 & 2.12. a code C can

- i. detect up to s errors in any codeword if $d(C) \geq s + 1$
- ii. correct up to t errors in any codeword if $d(C) \geq 2t + 1$

This is, the spheres of radius t centered on the codewords of C are disjoint (ie. have no overlap).

So, if $\leq t$ errors occur, then the received vector y may be different from the sent codeword x , hence being different from the centre of the sphere $S(x, t)$, but can not 'escape' from the sphere, so is 'drawn back' to x by nearest neighbour decoding.



Definition (Perfect codes). A code which achieves the sphere-packing bound is called a *perfect code*. Thus, for a perfect t -error-correcting code, the M spheres of radius t centred on codewords 'fill' the whole space F_q^n without overlapping.

In other words, every vector in F_q^n is at distance $\leq t$ from exactly one codeword.

Theorem (MLCT problem (Version 1)). For given length n , find the maximum dimension k such that $\exists$ an $[n, k, d]$ -code over $GF(q)$. (Then, for this k , $B_q(n, d) = q^k$).

Remark . *redundancy* r of an $[n, k, d]$ -code is just $r = n - k$ (the number of check symbols in a codeword).

Theorem (MLCT problem (Version 2)). For given redundancy r , find the maximum length n such that $\exists$ an $[n, n - r, d]$ -code over $GF(q)$.

Definition $((n, s)$ -set). a (n, s) -set in $V(r, q)$ is a set of n vectors in $V(r, q)$ with the property that any s of them are linearly independent.

Denote $max_s(r, q)$ the largest value of n for which $\exists$ a (n, s) -set in $V(r, q)$. ie.

- (n, s) -set: n vectors with s of them lin. independent

- $max_s(r, q)$: max n for which $\exists (n, s)$ -set

Definition (Packing problem). The *packing problem* for $V(r, q)$ is that of determining the values of $max_s(r, q)$ and the optimal (n, s) -sets.

Theorem 14.1. There exists an $[n, n - r, d]$ -code over $GF(q)$ iff $\exists$ an $(n, d - 1)$ -set in $V(r, q)$.

Proof. let C a $[n, n - r, d]$ -code over $GF(q)$ with PCM H . Then by Theorem 8.4, the columns of H form a $(n, d - 1)$ -set in $V(r, q)$.

On the other hand, let K a $(n, d - 1)$ -set in $V(r, q)$. If we form a $r \times n$ matrix H with the vectors of K as its columns, by Theorem 8.4, H is the PCM of a $[n, n - r]$ -code whose minimum distance is at least d . $\square$

Corollary 14.2. for given values q, d, r , the largest value of n for which there exists a $[n, n - r, d]$ -code over $GF(q)$ is $max_{d-1}(r, q)$.

$\implies$ the MLCT problem (V2) is the same as the packing problem of finding $max_{d-1}(r, q)$.

5.1 The projective geometry $PG(r-1, q)$

Let the vector space

$$V(r, q) = \{(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_r) \mid a_i \in GF(q)\}$$

Definition (Projective Geometry). $PG(r - 1, q)$

- *points* are the one-dimensional subspaces of $V(r, q)$
- *lines* are the two-dimensional subspaces of $V(r, q)$

Each point $P \in PG(r - 1, q)$, as a subspace of $V(r, q)$ of dimension 1, is generated by a single non-zero vector.

So if $a = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_r) \in P$, then $P = \{\lambda a \mid \lambda \in GF(q)\}$.

$\implies$ for $a = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_r)$, $b = (b_1, b_2, \dots, b_r) \in P$, then

$$a = b \text{ in } PG(r - 1, q) \text{ iff } a = \lambda b \text{ in } V(r, q)$$

for some non-zero scalar λ .

Lemma 14.6. in $PG(r - 1, q)$,

1. number of points is $\frac{q^r - 1}{q - 1}$
2. any two points lie on exactly one line
3. each line contains exactly $q + 1$ points
4. each point lies on $\frac{q^{r-1} - 1}{q - 1}$ lines

Proof. 1. number of points is $\frac{q^r-1}{q-1}$:

since each of the $q^r - 1$ nonzero vectors in $V(r, q)$ has $q - 1$ nonzero scalar multiples, the number of points of $PG(r - 1, q)$ is $\frac{q^r-1}{q-1}$

2. any two points lie on exactly one line:

if a, b distinct points of $PG(r - 1, q)$, then the unique line through them consists of the points $\lambda a + \mu b$, where λ, μ are scalars not both zero.

3. each line contains exactly $q + 1$ points:

in (ii) there are $q^2 - 1$ choices for the pair (λ, μ) , but we're identifying scalar multiples, so the number of distinct points on the line is

$$\frac{q^2 - 1}{q - 1} = q + 1$$

4. each point lies on $\frac{q^{r-1}-1}{q-1}$ lines:

let t be the number of lines on which a point P lies. Let the set

$$X = \{(Q, L) \mid Q \text{ is a point } \neq P, L \text{ is a line containing both } P \text{ and } Q\}$$

Count the members of X in two ways:

for each of the $\frac{q^r-1}{q-1} - 1$ choices of Q , $\exists!$ line containing P and Q . Thus,

$$|X| = \frac{q^r - 1}{q - 1} - 1 = \frac{q^r - q}{q - 1}$$

On the other hand, for each of the t lines through P , there are (by (iii)) q points Q other than P lying on L .

Thus, $|X| = tq$,

$$\implies tq = \frac{q^r - q}{q - 1}, \quad \implies t = \frac{q^{r-1} - 1}{q - 1}$$

□

Definition (Projective plane). The $PG(2, q)$ is called the *projective plane* over $GF(q)$.

6 MDS Codes

Theorem 15.1. a $[n, n - r, d]$ -code satisfies $d \leq r + 1$.

Proof. let C a $[n, n - r, d]$ -code, let $G = [I_{n-r} \mid A]$ be a standard form GM of C .

Since A has r columns, the codewords which are rows of G have weight $\leq r + 1$, ie. $w(C) \leq r + 1$.

The result follows from Theorem 5.2,

$$\begin{aligned} \implies w(C) &= d(C) \\ \implies d(C) &\leq r + 1. \end{aligned}$$

□

Definition (MDS). a $[n, n - r, r + 1]$ -code,

ie. a linear code of redundancy r whose min. distance is $r + 1$,
is called a *maximum distance separable code*, MDS.

→ by Theorem ??, max length of a MDS code over $GF(q)$ is $\max_r(r, q)$,
the largest size of a (n, r) -set in $V(r, q)$.

Conjecture 15.2. if $2 \leq r \leq q$, then $\max_r(r, q) = q + 1$
(except $\max_3(3, q) = \max_{q-1}(q - 1, q) = q + 2$ if $q = 2^h$)

Theorem 15.3. if $r \geq q$, then $\max_r(r, q) = r + 1$. Any MDS code of redundancy $r \geq q$ is equivalent to a repetition code of length $r + 1$.

Proof. repetition code of length $r + 1$: a $[r + 1, 1, r + 1]$ -code with GM $[1 \ 1 \ \dots \ 1]$.

Hence $\max_r(r, q) \geq r + 1$.

Also, any $[r + 1, 1, r + 1]$ -code is equivalent to a repetition code.

Suppose $r \geq q$ and by contradiction that $\max_r(r, q) \geq r + 2$.

Then, $\exists$ a $[r + 2, 2, r + 1]$ -code C over $GF(q)$.

→ C must be equivalent to a code having GM:

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & \dots & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & a_1 & a_2 & \dots & a_r \end{bmatrix}$$

in order that any linear combination of the rows of G has weight at least $r + 1$ with $0 \neq a_i \in GF(q)$.

This implies $r \leq q - 1$, contradiction. □

Remark . the only binary MDS codes are

$V(n, 2)$, the even weighted codes E_n , and repetition codes.

Theorem 15.4. let $2 \leq r \leq q$, let $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_{q-1} \in GF(q)$ nonzero.

Then,

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & \dots & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ a_1 & a_2 & \dots & a_{q-1} & 1 & 0 \\ a_1^2 & a_2^2 & \dots & a_{q-1}^2 & 1 & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots & \vdots & \vdots \\ a_1^{r-1} & a_2^{r-1} & \dots & a_{q-1}^{r-1} & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

is the PCM of a MDS $[q + 1, q + 1 - r, r + 1]$ -code.

Equivalently, the columns of H form a $(q + 1)$ -arc in $PG(r - 1, q)$.

Proof. the determinant of a matrix formed by any r columns of H is equal to the determinant of a Vandermonde matrix, and so is non-zero (see a proof of this at section 6.1). Thus any r columns of H are linearly independent. $\square$

Corollary 15.7. The dual code of a MDS code is also MDS.

Corollary 15.8. $\exists$ a MDS $[n, k]$ -code over $GF(q)$ iff $\exists$ a MDS $[n, n - k]$ -code over $GF(q)$.

6.1 Vandermonde determinant

This section contains a simple proof of the Vandermonde matrix determinant. The proof was found in [3], here it is written with small modifications and expanded. A different proof can be found in [4].

Lemma (Vandermonde determinant).

$$\det V(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 & x_1^2 & \dots & x_1^{n-1} \\ 1 & x_2 & x_2^2 & \dots & x_2^{n-1} \\ 1 & x_3 & x_3^2 & \dots & x_3^{n-1} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ 1 & x_n & x_n^2 & \dots & x_n^{n-1} \end{pmatrix} = \prod_{j < i} (x_i - x_j)$$

Proof. The equation is true for $n = 2$, as we have:

$$\det V(x_1, x_2) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 \\ 1 & x_2 \end{pmatrix} = x_2 - x_1$$

We now assume that $n \geq 3$. Starting with column n and ending at column 2, we successively apply the following operation: subtract x_1 times column $i - 1$ from column i . The determinant remains the same and the resulting matrix is:

$$\begin{aligned} &= \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 - (x_1 \cdot 1) & x_1^2 - (x_1 \cdot x_1) & \dots & x_1^{n-1} - (x_1 \cdot x_1^{n-2}) \\ 1 & x_2 - (x_1 \cdot 1) & x_2^2 - (x_1 \cdot x_2) & \dots & x_2^{n-1} - (x_1 \cdot x_2^{n-2}) \\ 1 & x_3 - (x_1 \cdot 1) & x_3^2 - (x_1 \cdot x_3) & \dots & x_3^{n-1} - (x_1 \cdot x_3^{n-2}) \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ 1 & x_n - (x_1 \cdot 1) & x_n^2 - (x_1 \cdot x_n) & \dots & x_n^{n-1} - (x_1 \cdot x_n^{n-2}) \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 1 & (x_2 - x_1) & x_2(x_2 - x_1) & \dots & x_2^{n-2}(x_2 - x_1) \\ 1 & (x_3 - x_1) & x_3(x_3 - x_1) & \dots & x_3^{n-2}(x_3 - x_1) \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ 1 & (x_n - x_1) & x_n(x_n - x_1) & \dots & x_n^{n-2}(x_n - x_1) \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Applying the Laplace expansion along the first row and factoring out the scalar multiples $(x_i - x_1)$ in each column, we obtain:

$$= \det \begin{pmatrix} x_2 - x_1 & x_2^2 - x_1 x_2 & x_2^3 - x_1 x_2^2 & \dots & x_2^{n-1} - x_1 x_2^{n-2} \\ x_3 - x_1 & x_3^2 - x_1 x_3 & x_3^3 - x_1 x_3^2 & \dots & x_3^{n-1} - x_1 x_3^{n-2} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ x_n - x_1 & x_n^2 - x_1 x_n & x_n^3 - x_1 x_n^2 & \dots & x_n^{n-1} - x_1 x_n^{n-2} \end{pmatrix}$$

in each row, factor out $(x_i - x_1)$

$$= \det \begin{pmatrix} 1(x_2 - x_1) & x_2(x_2 - x_1) & x_2^2(x_2 - x_1) & \dots & x_2^{n-2}(x_2 - x_1) \\ 1(x_3 - x_1) & x_3(x_3 - x_1) & x_3^2(x_3 - x_1) & \dots & x_3^{n-2}(x_3 - x_1) \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ 1(x_n - x_1) & x_n(x_n - x_1) & x_n^2(x_n - x_1) & \dots & x_n^{n-2}(x_n - x_1) \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= \prod_{2 \leq i \leq n} (x_i - x_1) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_2 & x_2^2 & \dots & x_2^{n-2} \\ 1 & x_3 & x_3^2 & \dots & x_3^{n-2} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ 1 & x_n & x_n^2 & \dots & x_n^{n-2} \end{pmatrix}$$

now, by induction

$$= \prod_{i=2}^n (x_i - x_1) \cdot \prod_{2 \leq j < i \leq n} (x_i - x_j) = \prod_{1 \leq j < i \leq n} (x_i - x_j)$$

□

References

- [1] Raymond Hill. A First Course in Coding Theory, 1986.
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